CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

ELDER CARE COMPANION (PRO) IN THE AI ERA

Robots can remind. They can't sit with someone's mother, notice she's quieter today, and know what that means.

★ TL;DR — Professional elder companionship at a ~$45K median, startable in 1–6 months with character and references as the entry ticket. The catch: you will attach to people in their final chapter — the goodbye is part of the job description. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

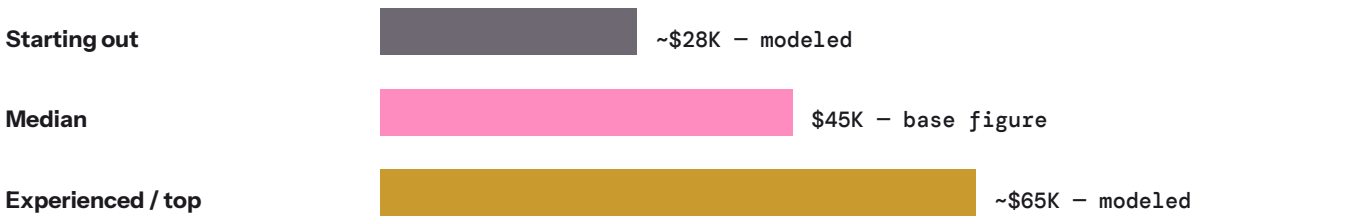
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- The product is human presence for people whose families can't be there — software doesn't substitute.
- Agencies provide structure; private clients provide the premium rates. Both run on trust.
- Noticing — appetite, mood, mobility changes — is the professional core disguised as conversation.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Elder Care Companion (pro) is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A ELDER CARE COMPANION (PRO) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Companionship: conversation, games, walks and outings
- ✓ Meals, light household help and errands
- ✓ Routine support and gentle medication reminders
- ✓ Updating family members and coordinating with other caregivers

Think: a professional friend with a checklist — warmth on the surface, vigilance underneath.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Reminder apps, family-update tools and home monitoring tech support the edges of care. They report data; they do not sit with a person.	Presence, patience and noticing change early. Families pay for a person who treats their parent as a person — and who calls when something seems off.

⚠ **Emotional labor is the whole product. Without boundaries and support of your own, you will burn out quietly and completely.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Meaningful one-on-one work at a human pace ✓ Grateful families and real relationships ✓ Calmer setting than almost any care job	✗ Grief is scheduled into the career ✗ Physically assisting aging bodies at moments ✗ Family dynamics you didn't create but must navigate

Good fit? Warm, observant, unhurried — with the emotional steadiness this work quietly demands.
Bad fit? Loss overwhelms you, or you need fast-paced, impersonal work.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — HOME-CARE AGENCY	DOOR B — PRIVATE CLIENTS
Agencies hire companions, match clients and cover scheduling and backup. Steady hours and structure make it the reliable first version of this career.	Build a small roster of private families through referrals. Premium rates and deep relationships, with all the vetting, scheduling and boundaries on you.

Smart move: Specialize in dementia-experienced companionship. Trained patience there is rare, families know it, and they pay for it like it matters — because it does.

Where you land after: Senior companion, dementia-care specialist, or an agency care-coordination role.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
ASSEMBLE YOUR	ADD BASIC	APPLY OR	TRIAL SHIFTS	BUILD YOUR	SPECIALIZE AND

STEP 1 — Assemble your proof

FREE · TODAY

- Document caregiving experience — family care counts, described honestly
- Line up references who can speak to your patience and reliability

STEP 2 — Add basic training

LOW COST · WEEKS 1-4

- Complete first-aid and CPR training
- Study dementia communication basics if you'll specialize there

STEP 3 — Apply or present

MONTHS 1-2

- Apply to home-care agencies for structured starts
- Or build a private profile for referral networks and community groups

STEP 4 — Trial shifts and matching

MONTHS 2-3

- Meet clients and families; chemistry matters for everyone
- Agree duties clearly: companionship scope, household tasks, driving

STEP 5 — Build your roster

MONTHS 3-5

- Set a sustainable weekly schedule across clients
- Communicate with families proactively — updates are trust

STEP 6 — Specialize and stabilize

MONTHS 5-6

- Take the dementia or end-of-life companion training that deepens your tier
- Let referrals from grateful families set your rate

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: write down your caregiving experience and collect two references.

□ Days 1–30: safety training done; agency applications submitted.

- Days 31–60: client meetings and trial shifts underway.
- Days 61–90: a regular weekly roster forming with written agreements.
- Day 90: you're a working professional companion with families who rely on you.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ PRESENCE IS THE CARE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.